

BLAKE PASSE

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EDUCATION

Duke University

Aug 2023 – May 2027

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

Durham, NC

- **GPA:** 3.93/4.00 | **Honors:** Dean's List with Distinction, Duke Launch (~20 undergrad invitees), Pentagon Invitee
- **Activities:** American Grand Strategy, Club Baseball, Sand Volleyball, Club Triathlon, Neuroscience FOCUS

Y Combinator

Sep 2025 – Dec 2025

Founder & CEO

San Francisco, CA

- Awarded \$500k & attended Y Combinator, the startup accelerator behind Airbnb and Stripe (~0.5% acceptance rate)
- Pitched to 20+ investors during an 8-hour Demo Day attended by 1,000+ investors

University of Oxford

Jun 2025 – Aug 2025

Ethics & Philosophy of AI Study Abroad | **GPA:** 4.00/4.00

Oxford, England

- Debated US-China AI competition and autonomous weapons governance across 6 hour-long Oxford faculty tutorials

Wabasha – Kellogg High School

Aug 2019 – Jun 2023

Class President

Wabasha, MN

- **GPA:** 4.00/4.00 | **ACT:** 36 | **Class Rank:** 1 | Varsity Baseball & Basketball Captain | Concert Band President

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Articulate AI Inc.

Aug 2025 – Mar 2026

Founder & CEO

San Francisco, CA

- Received \$500k seed funding from Y Combinator & \$200k from Great Wave Ventures, Benjamin Bryant, et al.
- Engineered computer vision ensemble, improving clash detection accuracy by 47% in construction imagery
- Founded initial speech therapy AI product (via ElevenLabs), assessing market fit through 400+ customer calls before pivoting to a better construction tech opportunity; navigated FERPA/COPPA compliance via SOC 2 audits
- Architected full-stack product infrastructure spanning frontend (Vercel), backend/database (Supabase), deployment & CV inference (Render, YOLO on AWS), and payments (Stripe)

Northrop Grumman

May 2025 – Jun 2025

Artificial Intelligence Intern

Plymouth, MN

- Built an end-to-end OSINT pipeline for the Russia-Ukraine war, structuring ~25k rows of unstructured social media text and historical strike records into an LLM-based forecasting system for missile strike likelihood by region
- Briefed ~10 senior leaders on internship deliverables and the current AI capabilities landscape, proposing a roadmap to productionize the prototype via a custom NER training pipeline and model fine-tuning
- Attended frequent meetings with ~20 company AI experts & C-suite executives to discuss enterprise AI governance

Mayo Clinic Artificial Intelligence Laboratory

May 2024 – Oct 2024

Artificial Intelligence Researcher

Rochester, MN

- Led LLM quantization research; published abstract in the Journal of Imaging Informatics in Medicine as lead author
- Created neural foramen segmentation & classification pipeline; finetuned YOLOv5 for accurate bounding box labels
- Delivered a presentation at the Boston Conference on Machine Intelligence in Medical Imaging to 90+ clinicians

Oddz for iMessage

Dec 2024 – Present

Founder

Durham, NC

- Built a native iMessage app in Swift, peaking as the 17th ranked app in the Apple App Store entertainment category
- Ran A/B tests across 6 ad creative variants on 2 social platforms to optimize targeting and messaging for app growth

Duke Applied Machine Learning Course

Dec 2024 – May 2025

Teaching Assistant

Durham, NC

- Taught tabular ML, CV, LLM, transformer, ResNet, Deep Q-Learning & RL concepts; utilized PyTorch & NumPy

Duke Hospital Bass Connections Research Group

Aug 2024 – May 2025

Quantitative Researcher

Durham, NC

- Selected for 35-member team; refined 120k+ traumatic brain injury dataset; improved representativeness by ~52%
- Presented research poster, grounded in 28 clinician interviews, at Duke's 250+ attendee Bass Symposium

SKILLS & INTERESTS

- **Skills:** Full-stack development, NLP, RAG, computer vision, OSINT, agentic & voice AI systems
- **Interests:** Minnesota Twins, geography, sand volleyball, skiing, Duke Basketball, piano, weightlifting, bouldering
- **Technical Proficiency:** Python, PyTorch, scikit-learn, Pandas, Hugging Face, YOLO, SwiftUI, AWS, Git